Yoshino Japanese Cedar

Cryptomeria japonica 'Yoshino'

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Overlook: 3 **TOTAL 3**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available

Not available

Flower
Not available



Leaf close-up
Library candidate

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Evergreen
Mature size: 30–40 ft. Confirmed by Missouri Botanical Garden, Clemson HGIC, plant lust, multiple nurseries. × 15–30 ft. Confirmed range.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. Hardy Zones 5–8/9. Cultivar of Japanese cedar. Fast growing for the species. Performs in Atlanta with good drainage and moisture. Less winter bronzing than many Cryptomeria. Good screen or specimen. Restart pass (2026-10-13): NC State confirms 50–70 ft for species, moist acidic soils preferred. Woodlanders notes 'Yoshino' as Southeast screening standard. [https://plants.ces.ncsu.edu/plants/cryptomeria-japonica/]
Sun: Full sun to part shade.
Water: Medium. Prefers moist, well-drained soil. Do not allow to dry out completely when young.
Soil: Moist, well-drained, organic. Prefers acidic. Avoid wet or compacted soils.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun to part shade in moist, well-drained soil. Protect from drying winds. Water regularly until established. Suitable as screen, windbreak, or specimen. Minimal pruning. Fast growth.
Soil prep: Moist, well-drained, organic. Prefers acidic. Avoid wet or compacted soils.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Cultivar of Japanese cedar. Faster growing with better color retention than species. Selected for landscape use.
Form / habit: Evergreen conifer. Symmetrical pyramidal. Fast growth. Dense. Becomes broader with age.
Foliage: None (evergreen). Minimal bronzing in winter.
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Reddish-brown, exfoliating.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Generally low issues when well-sited. Possible root rot in wet soils. Less winter bronzing than species. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a incidence is thin.
Not stated
Additional:
- Soft blue-green to lime-green needles. - Symmetrical pyramidal form. - Faster growth and better winter color than species. - Aromatic foliage. - Good replacement for Leyland cypress noted by some sources.